proportions of a powerful country. MI's research division was a giant enterprise that produced research, assessment and position papers, EEI, and briefings on a daily, weekly, monthly, semiannual, and annual basis. The partners who were considered junior members of the Israeli intelligence community—the Mossad and the Shin Bet—had no direct input into the annual intelligence assessment, which as mentioned was the peak of the community's annual work cycle, apart from the raw intelligence material they provided for MI's research throughout the year.

For many years and throughout my career in the Mossad, I maintained close working relationships with the top ranks of the Intelligence Corps. I learned to admire them for their successes in achieving remarkable things in the face of the State of Israel's existential challenges. But even the best systems fail from time to time! And when the operational culture of the system advocates excellence that constantly expands its performance envelope, it is impossible not to take into account the existence of a virtual red line, the crossing of which means failure—sometimes a colossal failure.

The main qualities required of an intelligence officer in a decision-making position are:

- A continuous aspiration for excellence.
- In the right circumstances, knowing when to decide not to take action, in a work environment where taking action is the benchmark.
- Skepticism and, when in doubt before making a decision, remembering to apply the adage "Whenever there is any doubt, there is no doubt." (This is a statement that has practical significance— do not let yourself wrestle and debate without end. Make a decision!)
- Knowing how to constantly test your self-confidence, which is acquired over time and experience, and remembering that modesty is sometimes also an option.

As the Hebrew prayer goes, "I have been young, and now am old," and in the world of intelligence I have seen it all. I admit that I, too, have suffered, more than once, from one weakness or another relating to the essence of the qualities I mentioned above. And what is the message encapsulated in my words? I will say it in the most blunt and simple way possible: had I been the head of Military Intelligence after the Yom Kippur War, I would have demanded from the prime minister, in addition to the